

Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board

February 13, 2025

Scott Meckstroth, General Manager
Ojai Valley Sanitary District
1072 Tico Road,
Ojai, CA 93023

DEADLINE EXTENSION FOR THE CLIMATE CHANGE EFFECTS VULNERABILITY ASSESSMENT AND MITIGATION PLAN (CLIMATE CHANGE PLAN) FOR OJAI VALLEY SANITARY DISTRICT – OJAI VALLEY WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT, VENTURA, CALIFORNIA (NPDES NO. CA0053961, CI NO. 4245)

Dear Scott Meckstroth:

The Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board (Los Angeles Water Board) adopted Order No. R4-2023-0430, a National Pollutant Discharge Elimination System Permit and Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) for Ojai Valley Wastewater Treatment Plant, on December 21, 2023. Order No. R4-2023-0430 became effective on February 1, 2024 and requires the Ojai Valley Sanitary District (OVSD) to submit a Climate Change Effects Vulnerability Assessment and Mitigation Plan (Climate Change Plan) to the Los Angeles Water Board by February 1, 2025, which is 12 months after effective date of this Order.

On December 20, 2024, the Los Angeles Water Board received a letter from the OVSD, requesting an extension of the deadline to submit a Climate Change Plan for the Ojai Valley Wastewater Treatment Plant until November 1, 2025. OVSD identified the following tasks that still need to be completed to support the 9-month extension:

1. OVSD is currently in the process of soliciting consultant proposals to prepare the required Climate Change Plan.
2. When proposals are received, OVSD needs time to evaluate and present recommendations to the OVSD Board for consideration and approval.
3. It is estimated that OVSD will take two to three months to issue Requests for Proposals, obtain proposals, and contract the scope-of-work.
4. Consultants need 12-weeks to complete the draft Climate Change Plan.
5. OVSD staff, legal counsel, and the OVSD Board will need three to four months to review, discuss and amend OVSD's policy to accommodate the draft Climate Change Plan for OVSD's consultant to issue the final Climate Change Plan.

NORMA CAMACHO, CHAIR | SUSANA ARREDONDO, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Los Angeles Water Board staff requested additional information from OVSD to identify the reasons for the delay in initiating development of the Climate Change Plan. On January 28, 2025, OVSD identified a 25% vacancy rate in management and staff within the agency for most of 2024. As a result, OVSD focused on critical tasks to maintain operations and did not consider a budget for the climate change plan development.

Since OVSD is in the process of developing a Climate Change Plan and has been short-staffed since the NPDES permit was adopted, the Los Angeles Water Board has determined an extension to the due date for the Climate Change Plan is appropriate. However, since OVSD has already had over a year to develop a Climate Change Plan, Los Angeles Water Board staff find a 6-month extension to be appropriate to expedite the process. The Los Angeles Water Board hereby approves an extension to the deadline for submitting the Climate Change Plan from February 1, 2025, to August 1, 2025. Please submit the Climate Change Plan for the Ojai Valley Wastewater Treatment Plant by August 1, 2025. Pursuant to the California Water Code section 13385, failure to submit the Climate Change Plan by the due date may subject OVSD to administrative civil liabilities.

If you have any questions, please contact Steven Webb at Steven.Webb@waterboards.ca.gov or at (213) 576-6793, or Dr. Don Tsai at Don.Tsai@waterboards.ca.gov or at (213) 576-6681.

Sincerely,

Jeong-Hee
Lim



Digitally signed by Jeong-Hee Lim
Date: 2025.02.13
09:57:41 -08'00'

for Susana Arredondo, Executive Officer
Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board